Tools to be explored

Free

- Small seo tools
- https://smallseotools.com/
- Answer the people
- Quick js switcher (extension)
- Reddit
- Link whisper
- Ahrefs
- Google Trends
- Google Analytics
- Google My Business
- Google Insight
- Google Posts
- Google Structured Data testing tool

Paid

- Keysearch.co
- Semrush
- Rank map tracker
- White Sparks citation finder(citation)
- Bright local(citation)
- Meetup.com

Our Ranking Strategy

- Study Strategies
- Research factors
- Analyze business requirements
- Identify competitors
- Analyze and study competitor strategy
- Analyze an in-depth study of the current position and the factors involved
- Identify goals and milestones
- Identify what's lacking
- Focus on SEO fundamentals on every page
- Improve content where needed
- Figure out Where and What to update?
- Analyze performance
- Why aren't we ranked locally?
- Lookup for factors to Start Local SEO
    - Lot More to be planned In-depth ahead
- Build a strategy for mobile SEO
    - Coming soon!

👉 No silver bullets just consistent SEO :) *My Loop Document as an SEO Intern at Icon Pro Digital Solutions*

💫 Overview

Use this space to add background context, objectives and suggested timelines.
Add inspiration quotes here.

🎯 Goals

1. Learn SEO Fundamentals
2. On-Page SEO
3. Off-Page SEO
4. Technical SEO
5. Analytics and Monitoring
6. Understanding SEO Algorithms
7. Mobile SEO
8. Explore various SEO Tools
9. Content Marketing
10. Design the best working SEO Strategy
11. ---

SEO Fundamentals

Historical events

-> Excite**,** Altavista, Yahoo changed the way
-> Late 90s larry page & sergey brin worked on search engines and 1st used links as a signal of authority and trust.

Spiders

Also known as crawlers or bots, are automated programs used by search engines to systematically browse and index the content of websites across the internet.

Crawlers

Also known as a web crawler or web bot, is an automated program designed to systematically browse the internet by visiting web pages and following hyperlinks.

Difference between Spider and Crawler

The term "spider" is often used to emphasise the role of the bot in discovering and following links.
The term "crawler" is more general and emphasises the process of systematically browsing the web, which includes both discovering and fetching information.

Indexing

The process of storing and organising the information collected by search engine crawlers so that it can be quickly retrieved and displayed in response to user queries.

SERP (Search Engine Results Page) layouts

It refers to the visual presentation of search results displayed by search engines in response to a user's query.
the following are commonly found content types usually displayed above organic content.

- Advertisements
- Snippets
    - Paragraph
    - List
    - Table
- Shopping results as Product carousels
- Site links (if user searches for an intended brand)
- Image Pack (if an image can better explain the query)
- In Depth Articles (if a query is detailed)
- Knowledge cart (public domain or a google data stream partner)
- Knowledge Panel
- Local pack (includes a map and addressing a local query)
- News box
- Related Questions (people also ask section)
- Tweets
- Videos

Use of secure communication and Https

It is essential to use secure communication means and protocols, both in order to gain trust of user and rank well.

Site speed Factors

- Google spiders will be able to craw more pages in the allotted time to site your page
- First byte (first request response from server)
- Total download time
- Full render time

Use Webpagetest.org
Google page speed insights

Determine slow speed factors:

- Slow response time or static assets are slow - > improve caching or improve content delivery network
- Slow dynamic pages - > review site code
- Slow visual rendering -> review external resources

Robots.txt and sitemaps

- If u don't want google, to crawl the page add it to Robots.txt
- If u want to remove a page that is already indexed use Meta robots tag
- Use noindex follow command to prevent a page being found in the index but still have the spiders crawl and follow links on page
- Use noindex nofollow command to prevent a page being found in the index and crawled

URLs

The URL structure refers to how the web addresses (URLs) of a website are organized.
Keep following in mind while

- Relevance and Descriptiveness
- Use of Hyphens
- Short and Simple
- Avoid Dynamic Parameters
- Canonicalization
- Consistent Structure
- include Target Keywords
- Static vs. Dynamic URLs
- Create URL redirects for 404 pages

Redirect components

Source
Type of redirect
Destination

Types of Redirects

301 redirect (page has permanently moved)
302 redirect (page has temporarily moved)

Duplicate content and Rel Canonical

1. **Domain.com**
2. www.Domain.com
3. **Domain.com/index.html**
4. www.Domain.com**/index.html**

Problem:
Google will see each url as a different page and won't know which one we prefer sending users to.

Solution:
To solve this problem, set a server-side redirect to only one page of the above regardless of which url was the destination, or use “rel=canonical” tags in the header of the page.

Structured data

Schema.org is the most structured data markup composed by Google Bing, Yahoo & Yandex.

Types of Structured data

1. Micro data markup(in-line)
2. JSON-LD

Use Google Structured Data Testing tool

Status Codes

Status codes are three-digit numbers returned by a server in response to a client's request made to the server. These codes indicate the status of the request and provide information about how the request was processed. Status codes are a crucial part of the HTTP (Hypertext Transfer Protocol) protocol, which is the foundation of data communication on the World Wide Web.

- 200 all well
- 204 no content found
- 301 page has moved permanently
- 302 page has moved temporarily
- 400 server cannot understand request
- 403 server understood request but refused to authorise
- 404 page doesn't exist drop from index
- 500 server error, nothing visible to user and spiders
- 503 temporarily unavailable , come back later

Solve this error using screaming frog crawl

Inspecting your site for an audit

- Inspect element
- Moz bar plugin (displays domain and page authority and gives quick access to analysis tools)
- Webpagetest.org checking site speed
- Wayback machine for site history.

The Penguin update in early 2012 adjusted Google's algorithm to consider the relevancy of each link instead of a site's overall number of links.

Anchor text

The clickable text in html anchor tag

Types of Anchor text

1. Exact match
2. Brand
3. Generic
4. Naked URL

Link analysis Tools

- Moz
    - Page and domain authority
- Majestic
    -
- Ahrefs
    -
- SEMrush
    -

Link building

Process of getting other sites to your website

Refer to backlink course
Penguin update 2012
Hummingbird update

Types of Keywords

- Fat head
- Chunky middle

- Long tail

Keyword Research Tools

- Google Keyword Planner
- Google Trends
- Uber Suggest
- Answer the people
- Semrush
- Keyword Magic

Mobile SEO

- It refers to the process of optimizing a website for mobile devices to ensure a positive user experience and improve its visibility in mobile search engine results.
- First build a website for mobile and then responsively expand for desktop.
- Mobile first index in 2018
- Mobile site speed

Choices while designing Mobile site

1. Dynamic serving
2. Separate domain (subdomain of your site)
3. Responsive design

Page speed

It refers to the time it takes for a web page to load its content, including text, images, scripts, and other resources. It is a crucial factor in user experience and search engine optimization. Faster-loading pages tend to provide a better user experience, reduce bounce rates, and may rank higher in search engine results.

AMP (Accelerated Mobile Pages)

It is an open-source initiative aimed at improving the performance of web content on mobile devices. AMP HTML, AMP JS (JavaScript), and AMP Cache work together to create pages that load quickly on mobile devices.

PWAs (Progressive Webapps)

These are web applications that leverage modern web technologies to provide a native app-like experience on the web. PWAs aim to combine the best features of web and mobile apps, including offline functionality, push notifications, and improved performance.

Use google insights

User experience focus

- Clickable links
- Fonts
- Spacing
- Short lead forms

Ranking signals

Brand search volume

International SEO

- Consider cultural and colloquial differences
- Use one language and a native content writer
- Use local currency and contact number
- Use lang tag in html head
- Use Cctld (country code top-level domain)
- Geographical hosting and server location

Local SEO Optimization

- Based on wherever location u search your content
- Having a physical address in the area
- Nofollow links also weigh in local SEO
- Low authority web pages also weight at local level
- Citations play vital role in local SEO (NAP)
- Locational relevance
- Include location in all important components
- Working for another city where u don't have a physical location use local content silos
- Google my location to claim for the location you own
- Add utm tracking parameters to website link
- Try to spread your reviews between Google, Facebook, YouTube & Yelp.
- Make sure you respond to your reviews, especially bad reviews.
- Use Google My Business

Backlink Management

Backlinks:

- Definition: Backlinks, also known as inbound links or incoming links, are links from external websites that point to your site.
- Source: They come from other domains and websites, not your own.
- Purpose: Backlinks serve as a vote of confidence or endorsement from one website to another. They are crucial for search engine rankings, as search engines consider them as indicators of a site's authority, credibility, and popularity.
- Quality: Quality matters significantly with backlinks. High-quality backlinks from authoritative and relevant sites have a more positive impact on SEO.

Internal Linking:

- Definition: Internal linking involves creating links within your website, connecting one page to another within the same domain.
- Source: The links originate from pages within your own website.
- Purpose: Internal links help establish a site's hierarchy, guide users to relevant content, and distribute page authority and ranking power throughout the website. They contribute to a better user experience and can aid in SEO by improving the crawlability and indexation of your site.
- Quality: While the concept of "quality" is less applicable to internal links in the same way as with backlinks, it's important to use descriptive anchor text and ensure that the links make sense within the context of the content.

Types of links

1. Natural Links
2. Outreach Links

   A strategy in search engine optimization (SEO) where website owners or SEO professionals reach out to other website owners, bloggers, or influencers to request backlinks
1. Follow Links
2. NoFollow Links

Competitive analysis using SEMRush Tools

Backlink analysis
Link building tool
Backlink gap analysis

Types of Penalty

1. Manual
2. Algorithm

Link building Strategies

1. Content creation
2. Link Reclamation
    1. Broken links
    2. Recovered links
3. Find unlinked mentions
4. Broken Links redirecting to other similar content
5. Resource pages
6. Newsjacking
7. Sponsorships
8. Involve in local community
9. Find link opportunities in google

Link building campaign

Link profile + research + Competitive research + Link building tactics + efforts = perfect links

- Create an excel sheet to manage all created possible list of links opportunities
- Then perform outreach and get the links
- If u dont get the link get feedback
- Look for it as a future opportunity to avail

Keyword Research

Understanding the Business

- Ask question before u start research
- Ask about business goals
- Ask about target audience
- Seasonal trends
- Why
- What problem are they solving
- Design a solid discovery process
- Let them share their expertise

Query intent

- Understand why search intent are important
    - Know

    - Do
    - Website
    - Visit in person
- Information query
- Navigational query
- Transactional query
- Local query

Create a List

- Create concept bucket
- Brain dump and Brainstorm
- Competitor research

SEMrush tools

- Keyword overview
- Keyword magic
    - Closely related phrases
    - Estimate monthly volume
    - Trend graph (seasonality)
    - Keyword difficulty score
    - Competition score
    - SERP features
- Organic traffic insights
- Connect google analytics to search console
- Position tracking tool

Check Your Competitors

- Chek add phrases
- Pages with highest nm of links
- Link overlap
- Unique link
- Poor linking
- Page structuring
- Optimization elements

Create content

- High-level pages
- Primary category pages
- More detailed pages
- specific info pages

Growing your agency with SEMrush

Steps involved:

1. Find SEO Clients
2. Using SEMrush to create SEO pitch
3. Use Market Explorer for Your SEO Pitch
4. SEO campaign management
5. SEO report for Client
6. Paperwork

Preparing a pitch

- Well designed
- Easy to read
- Client oriented
- solid, in-depth data on prospect
- Well customized and contains relevant cases
- Explain process from boarding to ongoing work
- Show a comparison of how they are doing vs how the competitors are doing
- Use stats and graphs, things that look visually appealing
- List keywords they could rank better for
- Go through a basic site audit

Local SEO

Test different tactics and see what works for you

Depends upon

- Business vertical
- Business location

Factors to look upon

- LSRF (Local Search Ranking Factors)
- NAP info
- Schema markups

Schema.org

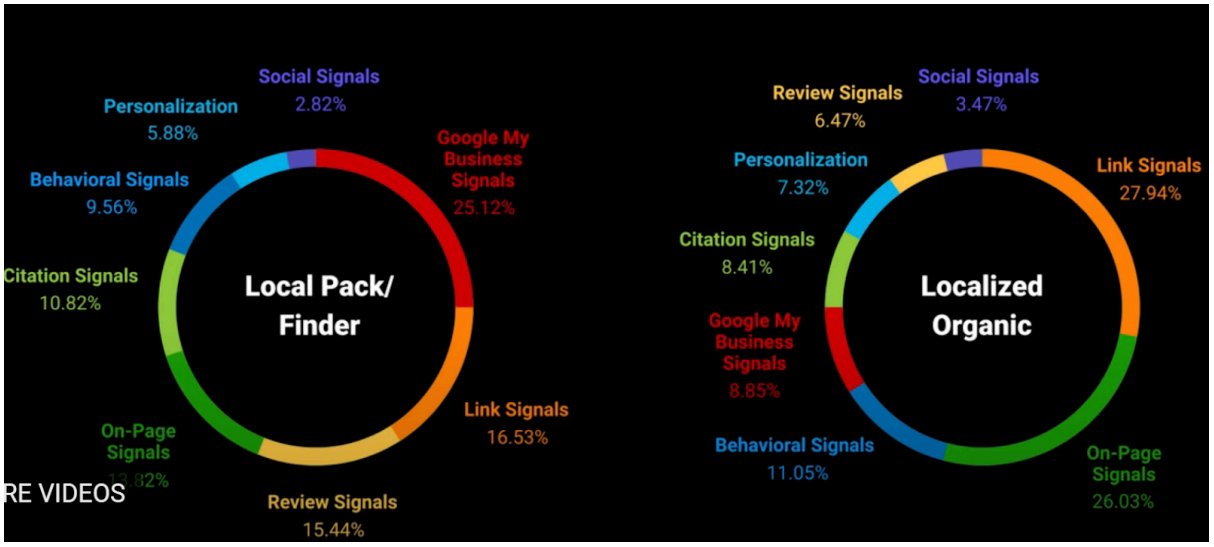
A collaborative activity to create, maintain, and promote schemas for structured data on the Internet, on web pages, in email messages, and beyond.Schema.org vocabulary can be used with many different encodings, including RDFa, Microdata and JSON-LD.

Local meetups

Meetup.com

- Sponsorship
- Employee Activities
- Neighborhood watch sites
- Google searches
- Look for similar businesses in different areas

Local SEO is different from Traditional SEO & Local Organic Traffic is different from Local packs



Focused more on:

Why are you the better option?
What makes you unique?
Write more local content
Use dynamic number insertion along with main contact and local number

Citations

1. Structured
2. Unstructured

Citations are foundation elements and need to be exactly matched and consistent.
/White sparks citation finder, bright local

Use Google My Business

- Claim your location
- Update it
- Update NAP
- Use citations
- Update current photos
- Go for customer reviews
- Use Googles posts and accurate description
- Answer Q&A
- Consider GMB profile as new home page

Google Posts type

- What's new
- Event
- Offer
- Product

Answer Q&A in your GMB profile

- Ask and answer common questions
- Make sure your answers are the most upvoted

Least affecting metrics

- Behavioral signals
- Personalization
- Social signals

SEO reporting charts

- Time on site
- Bounce rate
- Overall traffic
- Lead

Customize reports based on business goals

Mobile SEO

Tips for Mobile SEO

- Mobile searches have a higher buyer intent
- More searches conducted on mobile
- Previously desktop results were used for indexing websites but now the mobile-first index is used
- Google switched to mobile-first index
- Google recommends and prefers responsive sites
- Designing content for mobile and then convert it to desktop
- Use responsive CSS
- Do not block CSS or JS like previous mobile versions didn't support them so they were blocked back then
- Visibility problems occur if CSS or JS is blocked
- Do not use popups

Flash sites

Flash websites are built using an Adobe Macromedia technology called Flash. The visitor will have to have a plug-in (extra program on their machine) to be able to view the site. e.g. Click the image above if you wish to see how a Flash website looks. Flash has been officially retired with no official download sources, and Adobe has included a kill switch for Flash content. Modern websites have replaced Flash with more secure web standards. It is strongly recommended to avoid running Flash due to security vulnerabilities.

UX

- Keep clickable element a priority
- Clickable phone numbers
- Block clickable property of phone numbers for desktop users
- Create CTAs
- Create menus and sub-menus carefully
- Forms need to fit well
- Use custom keyboard for each form field
- Increase font sizes to avoid readability issues
- If required use different images for mobile

Mobile Site Speed

- Page speed is a ranking factor
- Page speed insight scores matter but actual loading speed may vary and cause trouble for users

Tips to optimize site speed

- Use quality hosting
- Use necessary plugins
- Prioritize content user see first
- Optimize images
- Use redirects carefully
- Optimize code
- Use caching
- Use CDN (content delivery network)

Types of Mobile sites

1. **AMP (Accelerated Mobile Pages)**
    - Amp gets stored on Google servers and limited analytics
    - Amp is usually for news sites
    - Get primary focus in search results
    - Faster because of its simplified content
    - Restricted to HTML and CSS
    - Example: News articles on platforms like Google News

1. **Native Apps**
    - Provide streamlined UX
    - Need to download
    - Need to be approved by Appstore or Playstore
    - Example: Instagram and Snapchat

1. **PWA (Progressive Web Apps)**
    - It can be downloaded from a browser
    - It looks like an app
    - It combines the benefits of native apps and mobile sites
    - It can send push notifications and function without the internet
    - Dynamic and interesting for users
    - Example: Twitter Lite

1. **PWAMP (Progressive web apps built out of accelerated mobile pages)**
    - Hybrid combo of AMP and PWA
    - Example: The Washington Post

In summary, AMP focuses on fast-loading web pages, PWA on providing a native app-like experience on the web, PWAMP combines the speed of AMP with the engagement features of PWA, and native apps are platform-specific applications with high performance and deep device integration. The choice between them depends on the specific requirements and goals of the project.

Mobile SEO and Local SEO

- Mobile searches are highly local
- 76% of searches resulted in customer visits and 28% converted to clients
- NAP info must be mentioned
- Consider local SEO factors

Solving Doubts

Key Differences between OpenGraph Meta tag & Meta description

OpenGraph meta tags are specific to social media sharing, while meta descriptions are more broadly used by search engines to provide concise information about a web page in search results.

Audience: OpenGraph meta tags primarily target social media platforms and influence how content appears when shared on these platforms.

Platform: OpenGraph is a protocol mainly used for social media, while meta descriptions are used by search engines.

Information Included: OpenGraph meta tags provide a structured set of information, including the title, description, image, and more. The meta description, on the other hand, is focused solely on providing a brief summary.

OpenGraph Meta tag

<meta property="og:title" content="Your Page Title">

<meta property="og:description" content="A brief description of your content">

<meta property="og:image" content="URL of your image">

<meta property="og:url" content="URL of your page">

<meta property="og:type" content="website">

Meta description

<meta name="description" content="A concise description of your web page content.">

.htacess File

It is a configuration file used by Apache-based web servers.

It can be used to load custom error pages (such as 404 pages), create URL redirects, implement password-protected authentication for specific directories on your server, and more.

Sitemaps

https://iconprosolutions.com/sitemap_index.xml

Robots.txt

https://iconprosolutions.com/robots.txt

Suggestions to update “Robots.txt”

User-agent: *

Disallow: /wp-admin/

Disallow: /wp-includes/

Disallow: /wp-content/plugins/

Disallow: /wp-content/themes/

Disallow: /wp-login.php

Disallow: /wp-register.php

Disallow: /xmlrpc.php

Explanation:

User-agent: *

Disallow: /wp-admin/: Prevents crawling of the WordPress admin directory.

Disallow: /wp-includes/: Prevents crawling of the WordPress includes directory.

Disallow: /wp-content/plugins/: Prevents crawling of the plugins directory.

Disallow: /wp-content/themes/: Prevents crawling of the themes directory.

Disallow: /wp-login.php: Prevents crawling of the login page.

Disallow: /wp-register.php: Prevents crawling of the registration page.

Disallow: /xmlrpc.php: Prevents crawling of the XML-RPC file.

Keep in mind that the robots.txt file relies on the cooperation of web crawlers, and not all web crawlers may adhere to its directives. While legitimate web crawlers generally respect these instructions, malicious bots might not. Also, note that using Disallow doesn't guarantee that a page won't be indexed—it just advises crawlers not to crawl it.

Permalinks

Permalinks, short for "permanent links," are URLs (Uniform Resource Locators) that are used to link to individual pages or posts on a website. In the context of SEO (Search Engine Optimization), permalinks play a crucial role in helping search engines understand the structure and content of a website.

Non-optimized permalink:

http://www.example.com/index.php?p=123

Optimized permalink:

http://www.example.com/seo-friendly-permalink

Our Ranking Strategy

- Study Strategies
- Research factors
- Brainstorm business requirements
- Analyse business requirements
- Identify competitors
- Analyse and study competitor strategy
- Analyse and in-depth study of current position and factors involved
- Identify goals and milestones
- Identify what's lacking
- Focus on SEO fundaments on every page
- Improve content where needed
- Figure out Where and What to update?
- Analyse performance
- Why aren't we raked locally?

Lookup for factors to Start Local SEO
Lot More to be planned In-depth ahead

- Build strategy for mobile SEO
- Maintain scores

🛠️ Project deliverables

Task	Assigned to	Due date
SEO Fundamentals		Thu, Feb 1
Effective working SEO Strategy		Thu, Feb 15

🔗 Relevant links

Add relevant links here.

SEO Project Brief & Potential Topics

👉 *It intends to brainstorm, research, and align ideas to rank Icon Pro Solutions at #1*

💫 Overview

Good SEO work only gets better over time...

🎯 Goals

1.

Questions ?

1. **What keywords do we want to rank for?**
2. **Can we update the Home page content?**
3. **What needs to be added?**
    1. We need to add our location to the website and other contact details that confirm we have a physical location in Quetta.
4. **Why aren't we ranked locally?**
    1. Not using Location and other local SEO Components
    2. Lack backlinks
    3. Lack Blogs about Local content
    4. Need to increase reviews both on google and Trustpilot
    5. Need to ask questions about internships and jobs on GMB
    6. need to decrease rating on google reviews
    7.
5. **What other companies are doing to rank higher in area?**
    1. they have more text content in their home page

1. **Do we need to rank for same keywords or consider ranking same keywords and content?**
2. **Do we need to analyze competitors?**
    1. yes! if we want to rank locally
3. **On what factors do we stand out but do not stand 1st?**
    1. Quality content and standalone website
4. **How can we create more backlinks?**
    1. any past interns or business associates
5. **Continue optimizing blogs and media alt tex**t

🧑‍💻 Team members

Name	Role	Location	Core working hours

🛠️ Project deliverables

Task	Assigned to	Due date	Bucket
Add Location to footer			
alt text to all media of icon			To do
update blog feature img			

🔗 Relevant links

Add relevant links here.

Potential Topics about Blogs

- Inspiration of events from Instagram
- Judged startups at NIC Quetta (2-3 times)
- Pakistan Startup Cup judged
- Training collaboration with NIC Quetta for SMEs (Small & Medium Enterprises)
    - content completed
    - keywords found
    - pictures found
- **Icon won Prime Minister Innovation Award** (product pitch-mysterious more details on the product later in the product reveal)
    - was it in 2022 & 2021?
    -
- Fulbright
- Cusetank win (Syracuse)
- twice (pictures) PSEB certification completion celebration

- icon completes its batch of interns in Quetta
- ask former interns and clients to give us testimonials, video, on google and Trustpilot as well Baneen Zahra
- Genz / youth working in a software house in Quetta which is skyrocketing the US clients' businesses
- journey of a new seo intern
- Awards in general an overview.
- View of Dean BUITEMS (Baluchistan's largest university) Quetta about Icon's Quetta Office / Icon from BUITEMS Dean's view
- CEO at awards from NY to Quetta
- Icon award winners
- story about 10 years of Mascot
- **Make categories**
    - one for students trying to find their north star in career trajectory - CTA: Come for Training/ Certification, mentorship, career counseling
    - local entrepreneurs: NIC and startups: CTA: Guidance, Trainings (1-3 day)/workshops, Mentorship, local business solutions (Web apps, websites, custom solution software, branding)
    - overseas clients:
        - show them they can trust us,
        - **They see us as experts in our domain**
            - This layout of website is proven to convert leads to sales
            - web development tips for entrepreneurs
        - CTA: websites/ getting business online / scaling business
- gather content from "answer the people" and humanize the resources found online to create a complete look of having expertise in that field
-

Potential Trending Topics

- Things you should know about web development
- Cloud Services
- Web App or Mobile App Development
- Freelancing Tips & Tricks
- SEO Newsletters and tips
- WordPress or Custom websites
- Trend of remote work
-

Titles for blogs to be designed

- 7 questions about web development in 2024
- 9 things you should know about cloud services

- Pros & Cons, Freelancing tips for 2024
- Navigating the Web Development Maze in 2024
- Embracing the Remote Work Revolution in 2024
- unlock SEO success with inspiring tips for 2024!

QA

for each page

Compare with design
check spelling & grammar
Check if all buttons & links are working properly
font check - whatfont extension
desktop: body size: 18px. line height across the site should be same

UI/UX:

see if sections & gaps are proportional
icons should be consistent

Forms: imp: check if the contact form & any other form within the site is working - double check which email the form is connected to

Responsiveness Check:

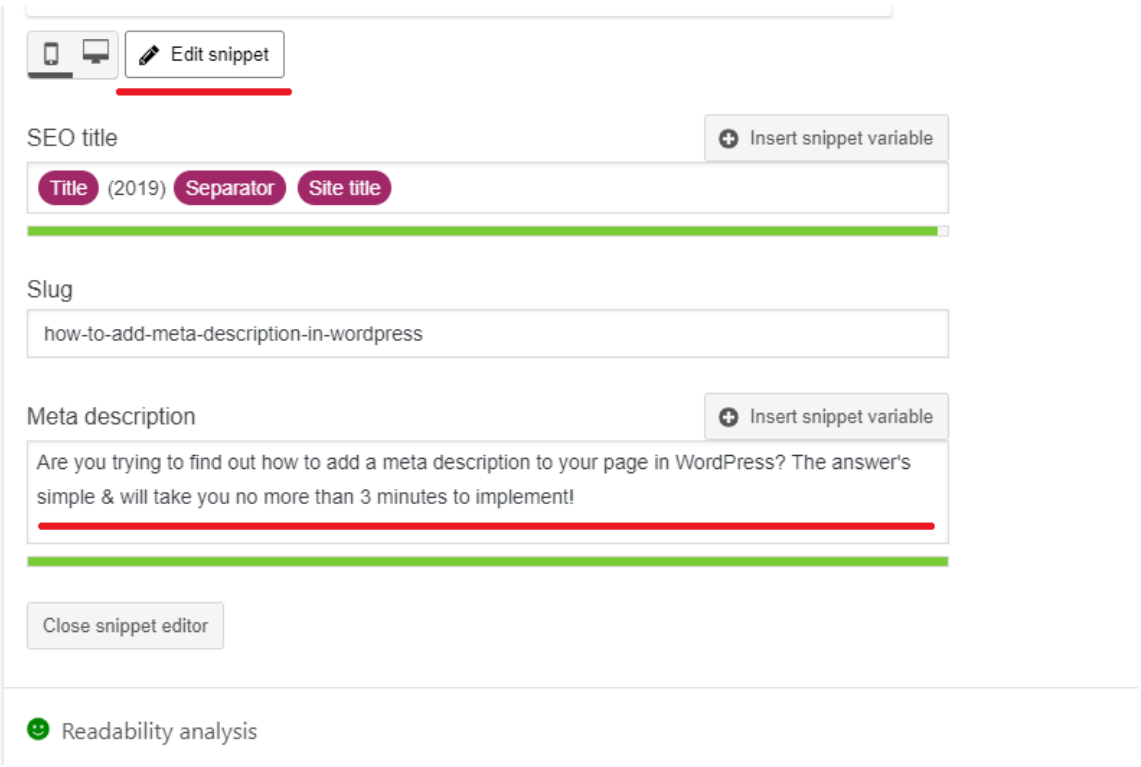
within browser: Breakpoints within inspect
check on physical devices
especially check the behavior on apple devices
mobile: usually buttons are center aligned
usually, body text size is 14 px

Baseline Practices of SEO for Team

Heading tag

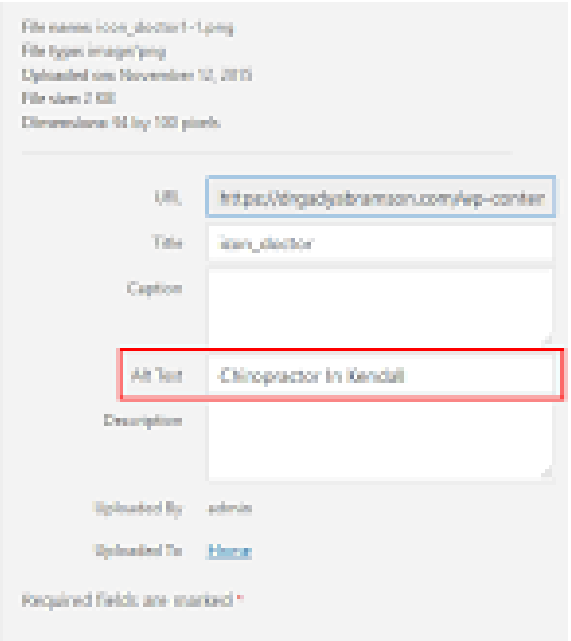
- Having main keywords or relevant synonyms in heading is essential for every webpage.
- The bigger the heading is the more it has SEO affect

Meta description



- add relevant meta description that is displayed below the title of page when searched, and tells more about the search result of the page better

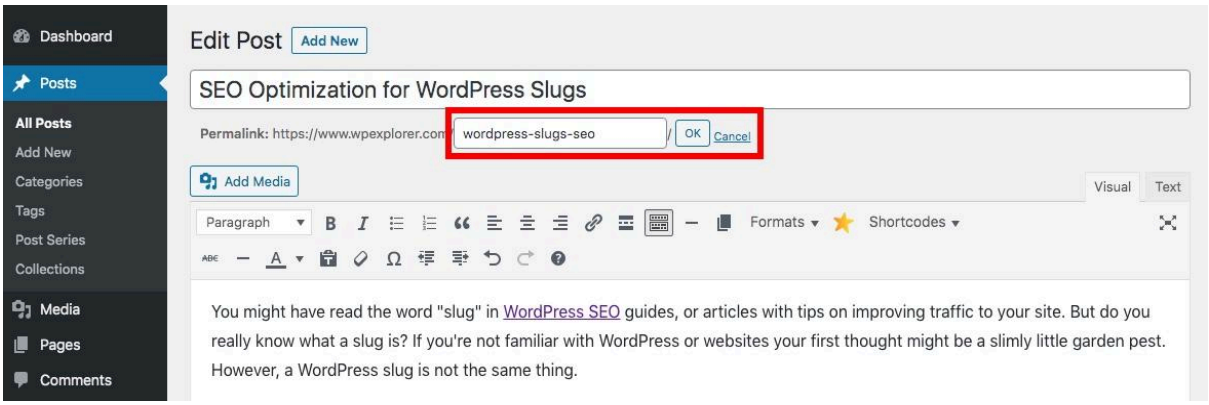
alt text for Images



- add relevant image description that helps blind users and bots know about what image is about.

slug

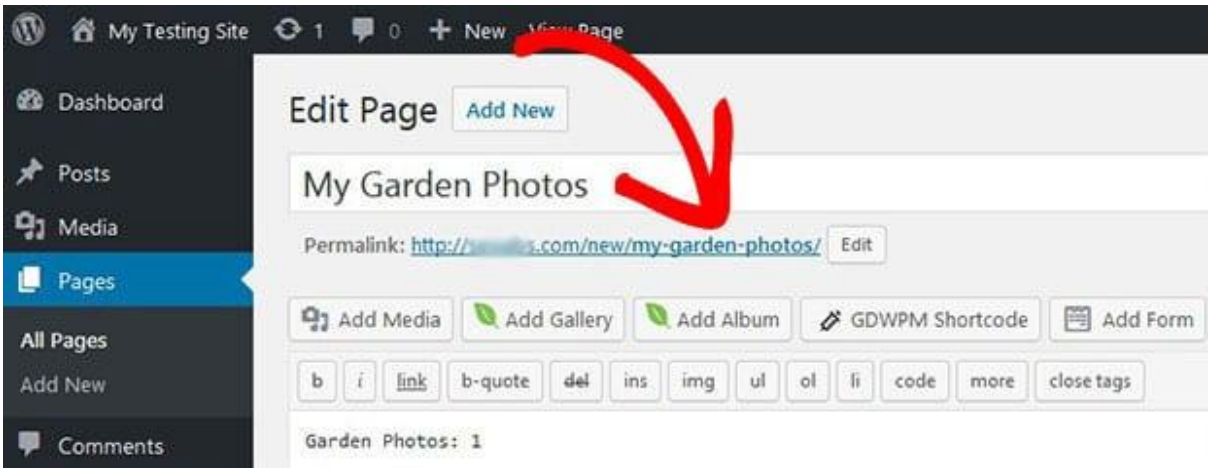
A **slug** is the last section of your url that identifies a specific page on a website. Slugs are set on a per page, post or taxonomy basis.



- add relevant slug separated by hyphen (-) that helps user know about the page better

permalink

Permalinks, short for "permanent links," are URLs (Uniform Resource Locators) that are used to link to individual pages or posts on a website



- have a look to the prmalink if looks fine

internal links

[Internal links in wordpress]

- try to link every webpage with another webpage inside the website making spider web like structures and make sure no webpage is left hanging on its own (orphan page).

anchor text

<a href="#anchor-links-wordpress-gutenberg">How to Create Anchor Links in WordPress with Gutenberg</a>

- Anchor text must be relevant as well and never left empty

CSS & JS files

- make sure you Minify the files to reduce load time of website
- https://wordpress.com/plugins/autoptimize this can solve the site load speed issue by minifying files in WordPress

Hiring & Offboarding

Onboarding Contracts & Steps

Checklist

- ☐ **Send Offer Letter**
- ☐ **Receive and record documents**
- ☐ **Record acknowledgement/ acceptance**
- ☐
- ☐

Offer Letter

- Give the location of office in email
- Job and internship both are in drive: HR - Human Resources\4. Company Contracts & Policies\1. Contracts & Templates\1. Onboarding Doc Templates
- Get them signed and scan it
- Give hard copy to employee/intern and ask them to email its scan as an acknowledgement to hr via their personal email account.

Contract

- Either copy an existing contract or use one from templates
- Discuss case of each employee/candidate
- Get them signed and either email the scan yourself or ask for an email acknowledgement along with scan from thei rend
- Keep the hard copy for office record

Getting Acknowledgement of signed Employment/internship Contract

Send this to their personal email address.

Subject: (Action Required) Welcome to Icon Pro Digital Solutions!

Dear <Name>,

Congratulations and welcome to the team. We are pleased to confirm your employment at Icon as a <Position>. As already aligned & agreed, your first working date on the job was/is <date>.

At our company, we cherish our unique office culture and the synergy within our team. We encourage you not only to embrace these values but also to become a vocal advocate for them, both within our organization and beyond.

Attached to this email, **you'll find your signed employment/internship contract and acceptance**. To complete the formalities, please confirm your acknowledgment of this email by <date>.

We are eagerly anticipating great contributions from you as a valuable member of our team.

Saving their acknowledgement for record

Once they acknowledge, save their emails on their respective files

Email Job Joining Acknowledgement - <employee name>

Offboarding

Resignation & Termination Notice

- Employee/employer must give their notice 45 working days prior.
- If company fires the employee for a just cause, no severance or dues are to be paid from company's end.
- **The last working month along with notice month salary will be given after completing the offboarding process and successfully completing the notice period tasks. Extra leaves that are not covered under PTO policy will be deducted from final settlement.**

Resignation letter and Email Acknowledgement

- The employee needs to send a resignation email from their **personal** email account keeping their official account in CC
- The HR will print the resignation as a letter and get it signed by the employee

Resignation Letter & Official Notice period Mail Template

From personal account keeping their official account in CC.

Subject: Formal Resignation - <Full Name>

Dear HR Team,

I hope this email finds you well. I am writing to formally resign from my position as an <position> at Icon Pro Digital Solutions, effective from <date>. My official last working day will be <last date>.

This decision is made at will, as I have chosen to pursue an opportunity elsewhere. As per company policy, I am committed to ensuring a smooth transition during my notice period. I will diligently complete any pending tasks and offer assistance in training a replacement or transferring my responsibilities as needed, fulfilling my professional obligations to the role.

I am grateful for the opportunities and guidance provided by the company during my tenure.

Sincerely,

[Your Name]

Resignation Letter if Cant serve Notice Period

To HR@iconprosolutions.com

From personal account keeping your official account in CC.

This is a template. feel free to change the sentences in square brackets.

Subject: Formal Resignation - <Full Name>

Dear HR,
Icon Pro Digital Soluitons (SMC) Pvt. Ltd.

I hope this email finds you well. I am officially sending my resignation as a <positon> from Icon Pro Digital Soluitons (SMC) Pvt. Ltd., effective immediately.

I understand that per our employment contract, I am obligated to provide a notice period of 45 working days. However, due to unforeseen circumstances, I find myself in a situation where I need to urgently relocate out of the city. Unfortunately, this renders me unable to fulfill the entirety of the notice period as agreed upon and aligned.

Additionally, as I have not completed the first month of probation, I acknowledge that I will not be compensated for the time I have spent at the company, as per the terms of the contract.

Furthermore, I want to reaffirm my commitment to upholding the confidentiality agreement outlined in my contract. I understand the importance of protecting the company's internal processes and will not disclose any information or utilize any work pieces created during my time at Icon Pro Digital Soluitons (SMC) Pvt. Ltd..

[I am genuinely grateful for the opportunities I have had during my time at the company, and I have learned a great deal from working with such a talented team. I sincerely appreciate the support and guidance I have received from you and my colleagues.
Thank you for your understanding and cooperation in this matter.]

Best regards,
[Your Name]

Intern Resignation

To HR@iconprosolutions.com

From personal account keeping your official account in CC.

This is a generated template. feel free to change the sentences in ***square brackets.***

Subject: Formal Resignation - <Full Name>

Dear HR,
Icon Pro Digital Soluitons (SMC) Pvt. Ltd.

I hope this email finds you well. I am officially sending my resignation as a <positon> Intern from Icon Pro Digital Solutions (SMC) Pvt. Ltd., effective immediately dated **<date>.**

I understand that per our contract, I am obligated to complete my internship period. However, due to <enter your reason>, I cannot uphold the contract at my end.

Additionally, as I have not completed even the first month of internship, I acknowledge that I will not be compensated for the time I have spent at the company.

Furthermore, I want to reaffirm my commitment to upholding the confidentiality agreement outlined in my contract. I understand the importance of protecting the company's internal processes and will not disclose any information or utilize any work pieces created during my time at Icon Pro Digital Soluitons (SMC) Pvt. Ltd. I will be available for any paperwork needed to close my role at your company.

[I am genuinely grateful for the opportunities I have had during my time at the company, and I have learned a great deal from working with such a talented team. I sincerely appreciate the support and guidance I have received from you and my colleagues.

Thank you for your understanding and cooperation in this matter.]

Best regards,
[Your Name]

Resignation Acceptance Email & Details (Last Working Day, Exit Interview Schedule)

- Last working date will be determined
- An exit interview schedule invite will be shared
- An exit interview form (template to create) to be shared beforehand
- Resignation acceptance email to be sent from HR to their **personal email** that includes the following details:
    - Notify their last working day
    - Explain their Notice Period Duties
    - Schedule the exit interview on Teams
    - Send them the Exit Interview form to be filled **before** the interview
    - Attach the **scan of their signed resignation letter/download of their email** and **Scan of signed offboarding contract**
    - Ask them to **acknowledge** the email
- Employee must acknolwdege the email

Resignation Acceptance Email

Dear <Name>,

We acknowledge receipt of your letter dated <date>, in which you voluntarily resigned from your position at Icon Pro Digital Solutions Pvt. Ltd., effective from <date>. Your last working day is <date>.

We have thoroughly reviewed our records and confirm that there are no outstanding dues owed to you by the company. **Kindly also acknowledge the same in reply to this email.**

We hereby accept your resignation from the position of <position>. Your last employment date would be <date>. We would like to thank you for your contribution to the company during your time here, and we wish you all the best in your future endeavors.

Your Notice Period responsibilities will be communicated and your last month salary along with your notice month salary will be credited after successful completion and hand over process. We would like to schedule a 20 minute exit interview with you on <date> and a form is attached to be filled **before** the interview https://forms.gle/5gbawztRH4msoYfr8 (kindly note that your answers within the form and exit interview will not impact your overall rating in any manner)

Please find enclosed with this email an attachment of original resignation email to the company, and your signed offboarding contract for your record. Have a great day!

-> Collect any manuals or files given
-> Take away the resources shared & close off outlook email & liscense

Notice period responsibilities

- Complete all pending tasks
- Complete documentation promptly
- Hand over all files and contents
- Hand over the work files and responsibilities to the replacement
- Explain and hold training sessions for the replacement so they can continue where they left off.
- Punctuality, behavior and work ethic should be maintained during the notice period, else the final compensation and offboarding will be affected.

Year-end bonuses, Leave encashment & benefits

If an employee resigns, they will not be eligible for benefits like leave encashment, bonuses and other gifts, even if they are on notice period when encashments, awards, and bonuses are being distributed.

Final Documentation on Last Working Day

If their pending tasks are complete:

- Share their Experience Letter
- Deactivate their official email
- Change any passwords shared with them earlier

- Update HR record
- Leaving contract sign
- NDA sign
- Get signature on the final settlement doc
- Transfer last salary
- Email their signed documents and get email acknowledgement
- Add comment in employee book if they should be considered next time if they apply again.

Email Templates

Interview Scheduled

Dear Applicant

I trust this message finds you well. Congratulations on being shortlisted at Icon Pro Digital Solutions.

Your online interview is scheduled for <date & time> via Google Meet. Please ensure you're ready 10 minutes before. The interview will last approximately 25 minutes.

The meeting link will be shared with you beforehand. Kindly acknowledge this email and prepare for the interview.

Best of luck, and we look forward to meeting you online.

Shorlisted

Hi <Applicant name>,

Congratulations! You have been shortlisted!

As the next step, we will be conducting interviews on **<date>** and a test a week afterward, to further evaluate your skills and compatibility with the role. We encourage you to prepare thoroughly and showcase your abilities during these assessments.

Please be aware that the competition is intense, as we have received a significant number of applications. However, we believe in the value of diverse perspectives and unique skill sets, and we are excited to see how you distinguish yourself throughout the interview and testing process.

We look forward to the opportunity to learn more about you during the upcoming stages of the selection process.

Additional Details

Hi <Applicant name>,

Thank you for applying to Icon Pro Digital Solutions. We have your resume and will touch base with you should we need any additional details from you.

The team will keep you updated on the status, if you wish to share anything additional that will make you stand out from the rest of the candidates, kindly do share that with us at your earliest.

General Rejection

Dear Applicant,

I hope this email finds you well. Thank you for applying to Icon Pro Digital Solutions SMC Pvt. Ltd.
We have thoroughly assessed your resume and portfolio and appreciate the effort you've put into showcasing your work. Regrettably, due to the high volume of applications from exceptionally qualified candidates, we are unable to proceed with your application at this time.

The decision-making process has been challenging, as we had to narrow down the list for final candidates, and the work samples of other shortlisted candidates particularly stood out.

We truly wish you the best in your professional endeavors and encourage you to stay connected with us for future opportunities.

Have a great day!

Skills do not align Rejection

Dear Applicant,

I hope this email finds you well. We appreciate the time and effort you invested in applying at Icon Pro Digital Solutions. After careful consideration, we regret to inform you that we are unable to move forward with your application.

We want to express our gratitude for your interest in joining our team. We received numerous applications from talented individuals, making the selection process highly competitive.

Unfortunately, we have chosen candidates whose backgrounds more closely align with the specific requirements of the position.

We encourage you to keep exploring opportunities that match your skills and expertise. Your commitment to professional growth is commendable, and we hope you find a suitable opportunity that aligns well with your career goals.

Thank you once again for considering Icon Pro Digital Solutions as a potential employer. We wish you the best in your future endeavors.

Best Regards,